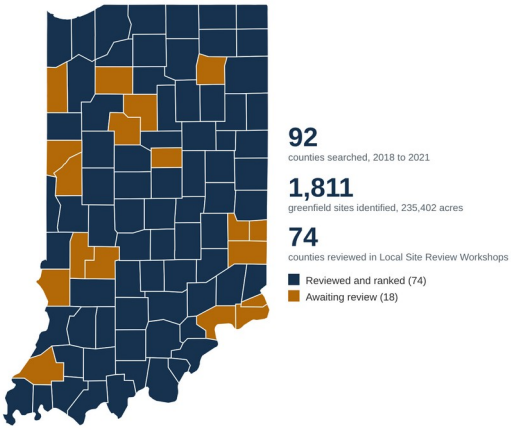
LOCATION Design Group

SSI PROGRAM

INDIANA STRATEGIC SITES INVENTORY (SSI) PROGRAM

# Program Chronicle, 2018 to 2026




A comprehensive record of the Indiana SSI Program: origin, phases, products, clients, partners, investment, results, and current status

**PREPARED FOR**

Office of the President
Indiana Economic Development Corporation
One North Capitol Avenue, Indianapolis, Indiana 46204

**PREPARED BY**

Victor Leotta, Director, Strategic Sites
Location Design Group, LLC, an ATK Energy Group Company

**DATE**

November 2026

*Companion document: The Case for Reinvestment in Indiana Greenfield Site Readiness. Figures are drawn from IEDC contracts, Leotta Location and Design (LL+D)/LDG proposals, invoices, delivery records, and IEDC public communications; sources are listed in Appendix A.*

# Contents

1. Executive summary
2. What the SSI Program is
3. How Indiana adopted the program
4. Chronology, 2018 to 2026
5. Phases, products, and deliverables completed in Indiana
6. Clients, contracts, and investment
7. Partners and people
8. Results and metrics
9. Program status in November 2026
10. Appendix A: Source register

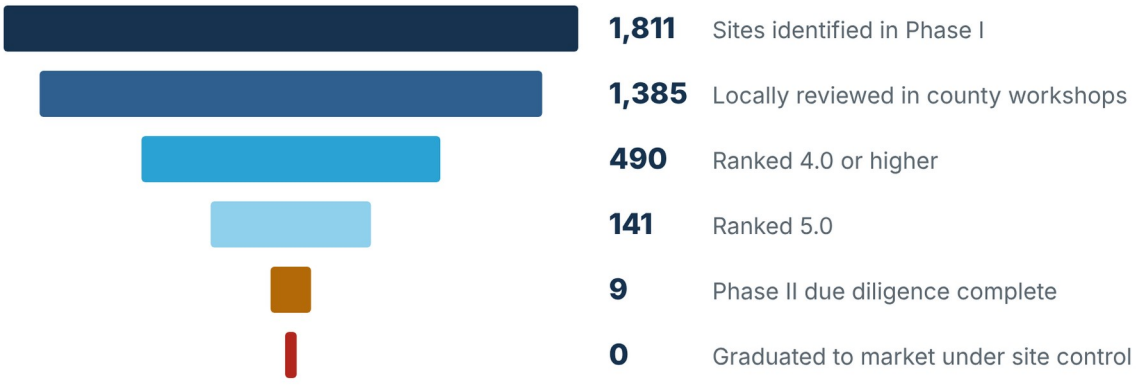
# 1. Executive summary

The Indiana Strategic Sites Inventory (SSI) Program is the largest single-state greenfield site discovery program ever conducted by Location Design Group (LDG, formerly Leotta Location and Design, LL+D), and by IEDC's own published description it is "the most comprehensive in the nation." Between December 2018 and November 2024 the program searched every one of Indiana's 92 counties, identified more than 1,800 previously unlisted greenfield sites totaling roughly 235,000 acres, vetted those sites with local officials in 74 counties, and ranked 490 of them at 4.0 or higher on the program's five-point readiness scale. It also produced a statewide Technology MegaSite search (69 candidate sites of 500 acres or more), a statewide utility-scale solar screen (38 sites, 10,142 MW), a hyperscale data center screen (58 candidate sites), 24 Phase II due diligence nominations with eight completed studies, a licensed SSI Portal used by IEDC, the Indiana Power Partners, and local economic development organizations, and the site readiness foundation beneath the LEAP Research and Innovation District, which IEDC markets as sitting "all on an SSI-certified (Strategic Site Inventory) site."

| 92 | 1,811 | 235,402 | 74 | 490 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| counties searched | sites identified | acres identified | county review workshops | sites ranked 4.0 or higher |

Indiana clients invested approximately $1.39 million in the program over seven years. IEDC invested $1,213,282 under three professional services agreements (2018, 2022, and 2023, the last amended through December 31, 2025). Indiana's electric utilities (Duke Energy Indiana, Wabash Valley Power Alliance, NIPSCO, Hoosier Energy, CenterPoint Energy, Indiana Michigan Power, and IMPA) invested a further $172,500 in Phase II due diligence and SSI Portal licenses. IEDC funding peaked at $274,847 in 2024, when the $250,000 program budget was fully consumed by July, and then tapered to two $25,000 amendments. The last Local Site Review Workshop was held in Kosciusko County on November 19, 2024, leaving 18 counties unreviewed. No Indiana SSI site has yet completed Phase III site advancement and graduated to the open market, which is the point at which the inventory converts to projects, jobs, and capital investment.

**THE SSI PIPELINE IN INDIANA, NOVEMBER 2026**



**Why this chronicle exists**

IEDC leadership has changed since the program was commissioned and funded, and the institutional memory of what was bought, what was delivered, and what remains unfinished now sits largely in LDG's files and IEDC's project records. This document reconstructs the full record so that a decision about the program's future can be made on facts. The companion document, The Case for Reinvestment in Indiana Greenfield Site Readiness, makes the argument for completing the job.

# 2. What the SSI Program is

## 2.1 Definition

The Strategic Sites Inventory Program is a proactive, advance site selection process that identifies a state's or region's most competitive undeveloped real estate for industrial and commercial investment, qualifies those sites through engineering and environmental due diligence, and advances the survivors to the open real estate market under site control. The program slogan has been constant since 2016: Quality Sites = Quality Projects = Quality Jobs. The methodology originated under LEO, LLC (Leotta-Evers Consulting) (Louisiana, 2008; Florida, 2013) and was formalized as the Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) SSI Program in 2016. LDG holds the Strategic Sites Inventory and SSI marks and delivers the program. By 2026 LDG had implemented SSI in 12 states, across more than 480 counties, identifying more than 6,800 sites and 1.72 million acres, and had conducted more than 400 local site review workshops.

## 2.2 What makes it different from site certification

Conventional certified sites programs evaluate properties that are already on the market, regardless of suitability, and typically depend on local nomination. SSI Phase I is a mining exercise: proprietary GIS suitability models screen every acre of a county against 12 to 15 criteria per land use, and the analyst team then discovers previously unknown sites of exceptional quality. Most sites identified through SSI are not on the market and have never been listed. The process is objective by design and, in the words of the 2018 Indiana proposal, is "designed to defeat political influence and motivations that compromise site inventory quality." The program does not compete with a sites and buildings database such as ZoomProspector; sites are published there only after graduation. SSI sites become, as the 2020 IEDC webinar FAQ put it, "high-survival feedstock for certification through existing site readiness programs."

## 2.3 The phases

| Phase | Purpose | Key outputs | Gate to next phase |
|---|---|---|---|
| Phase I: Site Discovery | Statewide desktop discovery by project land use (Megasite 1,000+ ac, Heavy Industrial 400+, Light Industrial 150+, Heavy Agribusiness 100+, General Agribusiness 50+, Technology MegaSite 500+, Solar, Data Center). | Core Suitability Models, individual site maps, county index maps, GIS boundaries, summary tables, Local Site Review Workshops (LSRW), SSI Portal access. | LSRW rank of 4.0 or higher qualifies a site for Phase II nomination. |

| Phase | Purpose | Key outputs | Gate to next phase |
|---|---|---|---|
| Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence | Desktop engineering, environmental, ecological, cultural resource, utility, transportation, and community review of nominated sites; rough order of magnitude site development costs. | Phase II Findings Report (Condition, Connection, Community), Candidate Site Index, Site Profile, NAICS business attraction brochure. | Favorable development opinion triggers Phase III. |
| Phase III: Site Advancement to Market | Landowner engagement, letter of intent and purchase option at fair market value, zoning and entitlement alignment, conceptual site plan, marketing package. | Site control instrument, development positioning, Site Profile, publication to the state sites and buildings database. | Site graduates to market. |
| Phase IV: Formal Due Diligence | Field investigation and testing for select large-scale sites (geotechnical, wetlands delineation, Phase I ESA, cultural survey). | Technical reports supporting construction-ready status. | Applied judiciously to top-tier sites. |
| Phase V: Branding and Marketing | Promotional package for graduated sites targeted to industry sectors. | Expanded Site Profiles, StoryMaps, map books, direct outreach. | Ongoing. |

## 2.4 The readiness scale

Every site that passes through a Local Site Review Workshop receives an SSI Competitive Rank from 1.0 to 5.0. A 5.0 site readily satisfies all permitting and development conditions, with all utilities accessible and no capacity concerns, compatible zoning, and good ingress and egress. A 4.0 site satisfies most transportation and utility requirements, generally lacks no more than one requirement, and can be made ready within about 12 months. A 3.0 site has good future potential with improvements expected within 18 to 36 months. Sites at 1.0 and 2.0 require significant time, money, and political will. The 4.0 threshold is the gate for Phase II nomination, Focus Site and FLEX classification, Phase III candidacy, and qualification for the SSI: Signals lead generation engine.

## 2.5 Indiana site classes

- **XCEL sites:** IEDC's designation for Indiana's top-tier, large-scale strategic sites (Technology MegaSite and Heavy Industrial scale). LDG produced Expanded Site Profiles for XCEL sites including the I-64/US-41 XCEL cluster in Vanderburgh County (three sites, 1,156 to 2,271 acres).
- **FLEX sites:** SSI Portal class created in January 2024 for sites over 100 acres, ranked 4.0 or higher, with no match to any ZoomProspector listing (newly discovered inventory).
- **Focus Sites:** Introduced in Indiana in 2021 for the utility partners: sites ranked 4.0 or higher within a utility's territory that had not previously been listed. The Duke Energy sheet identified 38 Focus Sites; the Wabash Valley sheet identified 53 brand-new 4.0+ sites.
- **Potential Technology MegaSites:** 69 sites of 500 acres or more in 26 counties meeting proximity criteria for population, universities, and research institutions (March 2022). IEDC's website now reports 70 potential mega sites.

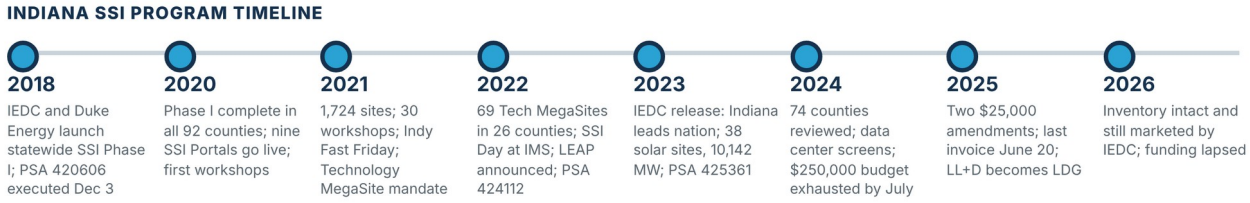
## 3. How Indiana adopted the program

The Indiana program began as a utility initiative. In March 2018 Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) proposed site readiness conceptual design work to Duke Energy Indiana, and between August 7 and August 29, 2018 Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) developed Proposal No. 18-044 for a statewide SSI Phase I. The August 29 revision was addressed jointly to Matt Wade, IEDC Vice President of Marketing, and Erin Schneider, Director of Economic Development at Duke Energy Indiana, and stated that "the intended contracting entity is IEDC with project funding provided to IEDC as a grant from the Duke Energy Foundation." Revision 1 (October 29, 2018) made IEDC the sole client, with Duke Energy assisting in the acquisition of county GIS data. IEDC executed Professional Services Agreement 420606 on December 3, 2018 (signed by Secretary of Commerce James A. Schellinger) for $190,598 plus a $7,500 annual SSI Portal license, a $198,098 not-to-exceed value.

The original scope was unusual in two respects that have defined the Indiana program ever since. First, it covered all 92 counties rather than a region or a utility territory; IEDC's November 2022 release noted that Indiana was the first state to fund a statewide search and that the program is unique in its focus on every county. Second, it was organized by project land use rather than by nominated property: Budget Year 1 searched for Megasites (55 counties) and Heavy Industrial sites (64 counties), and later budget years added Light Industrial, Heavy Agribusiness, and General Agribusiness statewide. The project kickoff meeting was held at IEDC on January 31, 2019 with a team of Victor Leotta (program manager), Holden Simoneaux (lead site analyst), Chris Ventre (technical director), and William Paul, P.E. (quality assurance).

A third defining feature followed in 2020: the Indiana Power Partners model. In February 2020 Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) prepared program advancement budget templates for each electric utility and in April 2020 delivered the first heavy industrial site packages by service territory, with customized SSI Portals for Duke Energy, AES/IPL, Wabash Valley Power Alliance, Hoosier Energy, IMPA, NIPSCO, Indiana Michigan Power, and CenterPoint/Vectren. The utilities became the program's second funding channel for Phase II due diligence and portal licenses, and the Local Site Review Workshops became the channel through which the 92 county economic development organizations engaged.

## 4. Chronology, 2018 to 2026




The table records every contract, scope, deliverable, event, and milestone identified in the program record. Dollar figures are the contracted or invoiced amounts; counts are as reported in the cited deliverable at that date.

| Date | Event, scope, or deliverable | Client / partner | Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| Mar 2018 | Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) proposes site readiness conceptual design work to Duke Energy Indiana (18-045); precursor relationship. | Duke Energy | |

| Date | Event, scope, or deliverable | Client / partner | Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| Aug 29, 2018 | Proposal 18-044 R0, SSI Phase I: Site Discovery, all 92 counties, addressed jointly to IEDC (Matt Wade) and Duke Energy Indiana (Erin Schneider); funding via Duke Energy Foundation grant to IEDC. | IEDC / Duke | $190,598 |
| Oct 29, 2018 | Proposal 18-044 R1; IEDC becomes sole client. | IEDC | $190,598 + $7,500 portal |
| Dec 3, 2018 | IEDC PSA 420606 executed (Sec. James A. Schellinger); contractors Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) and LEO, LLC (Leotta-Evers Consulting); Exhibit B SSI Web Portal License. | IEDC | $198,098 NTE |
| Dec 6, 2018 | Invoice 18-044-01: 50% project initiation plus portal license. | IEDC | $102,799 |
| Jan 31, 2019 | Project kickoff meeting at IEDC. | IEDC | |
| Apr to Nov 2019 | Phase I progress deliveries, Batches 1 to 6 (Megasite and Heavy Industrial). | IEDC | $79,934 |
| Sep 17, 2019 | FY2020 budgetary consideration prepared for Duke Energy Indiana and IEDC (Expanded Phase I, Phase II for 8 sites, Phase III, profiles, program management). | IEDC / Duke | $498,849 proposed |
| Dec 17, 2019 | Duke Energy Indiana funds its own SSI Portal license for 2020 (renewed every year through 2025). | Duke Energy | $7,500/yr (later $2,500) |
| Dec 2019 | PSA 420606 Amendment 1 extends term to Dec 31, 2020. | IEDC | |
| Feb 4, 2020 | Batches 7 to 10 delivered; original Phase I (Megasite and Heavy Industrial) complete statewide: 233 to 237 sites across 81 to 87 counties searched to date. | IEDC | $7,866 |
| Feb 20, 2020 | Duke Energy Indiana SSI Phase II, two sites (20-027); delivered for Vermillion Rise Mega Park (1,162.7 ac) in May to June 2022. | Duke Energy | $20,000 |
| Feb 25, 2020 | Program advancement budget template issued to each electric utility partner (Phase II, Phase III, profiles, portal). | Power Partners | $225,220 each proposed |
| Feb 27, 2020 | Proposal 20-007 R1, Expanded SSI Phase I: Light Industrial, Heavy Agribusiness, General Agribusiness statewide; seven utility portal sub-licenses. | IEDC | $278,629 + $10,000 |
| Mar 31, 2020 | PSA 420606 Amendment 2 adds Expanded Phase I (Exhibit C). | IEDC | +$278,629 |
| Apr 9 to 24, 2020 | Heavy industrial site packages delivered by utility service area; nine SSI Portals go live (IEDC parent plus eight utility portals). | Power Partners | |
| Sep 24, 2020 | IEDC statewide webinar, Indiana SSI Program: A Program Overview and Progress Summary, co-hosted with IEDA Foundation, Indiana Power Partnership, and Duke Energy. | IEDC / LEDOs | |
| Oct 12, 2020 | Proposal 20-050: SSI Portal access for 15 REDOs and 92 LEDOs (107 sub-licenses). | IEDC | $53,500 |
| Oct 16, 2020 | Progress: 977 potential greenfield sites; Light Industrial and Agribusiness searches complete in 37 counties. | IEDC | |

| Date | Event, scope, or deliverable | Client / partner | Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| Dec 1 and 4, 2020 | First Local Site Review Workshops: Montgomery County and Pike County. | IEDC / LEDOs | |
| Feb 26, 2021 | Batch E-09 (final): Expanded Phase I 100% complete, 92 of 92 counties screened; 1,700 sites discovered; average site 194 acres. | IEDC | |
| Mar to Jul 2021 | 30 Local Site Review Workshops completed in 2021 (the program's busiest workshop year). | IEDC / LEDOs | $82,500 |
| May 10, 2021 | PSA 420606 Amendment 3; cap $551,727; term to June 30, 2022. | IEDC | $551,727 NTE |
| May 12, 2021 | Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) donates $25,000 of in-kind consulting as Indy Fast Friday sponsorship. | IEDC | $25,000 in-kind |
| May 14, 2021 | Production of SSI Phase I Site Profiles commissioned (25 to 32 profiles). | IEDC | $49,600 |
| May 18, 2021 | Wabash Valley Power Alliance SSI Phase II proposal (21-038), up to 15 sites at $10,000 each; six sites funded 2021 to 2022, including Marshall, Tippecanoe, Adams, Parke, and Boone Counties. | WVPA | $60,000 |
| May 21, 2021 | Indy Fast Friday (IEDC event): 1,724 sites identified; 92 counties searched; 23 counties with completed workshops; 495 sites reviewed; 235 ranked 4.0 to 5.0. Duke Energy Focus Sites sheet (38 Focus Sites) and Wabash Focus Sites sheet (53 new 4.0+ sites) issued. | IEDC / Power Partners | |
| Jun to Nov 2021 | Technical support retainer work: RFI responses (Bartholomew County, Warsaw, Project Bravado), Indiana Ports, and 104.5 hours of LEAP District technical support (Proposal 21-065 reconciliation). | IEDC | $66,676 |
| Sep 30, 2021 | Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) drafts NIPSCO's SSI Phase II Site Preparedness Grant Program framework (NIPSCO 80%, LEDO 20%). | NIPSCO | |
| Oct 8, 2021 | NIPSCO SSI Phase II proposal (21-044): four sites in LaPorte (2), Lake, and Porter Counties, plus Kingsbury Industrial Park (22-065, 2022). Lowell I-65 Industrial Park Findings Report issued Dec 18, 2024. | NIPSCO | $40,000 |
| Oct 21, 2021 | Draft Proposal 21-047: Indiana Research, Innovation, and Manufacturing Mega-Region vision and baseline asset mapping (IEDC directive for a 10,000+ acre hyper-scale technology and manufacturing complex; precursor concept to LEAP). | IEDC | not contracted |
| Nov 10, 2021 | Power Partner Phase I summary sheets issued per utility (Duke: 570 sites, 70 ranked 4.0+; Vectren 793 sites; Wabash 453; Hoosier 393; AEP 251; NIPSCO 217; IMPA 180; IPL 42). | Power Partners | |
| Nov 30, 2021 | Proposal 21-061 R1, Expanded SSI Phase I: Technology MegaSite Search (500+ acres; 29 candidate counties) responding to Secretary Chambers' 2021 mandate for hyper-scale tech park sites. | IEDC | $65,250 |
| Dec 15, 2021 | PSA 420606 Amendment 4 (Sec. Bradley B. Chambers); cap $613,977; term to Dec 31, 2022. | IEDC | $613,977 NTE |
| Feb 7, 2022 | PSA 420606 Amendment 5; cap $679,935.04 (adds technical support reconciliation 21-065). | IEDC | $679,935 NTE |

| Date | Event, scope, or deliverable | Client / partner | Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| Feb 2022 | First SSI Phase II Candidate Site Index produced (for Wabash Valley Power Alliance). | WVPA | |
| Mar 25, 2022 | Technology MegaSite results: 69 potential sites in 26 counties; largest Pike County 5,200.9 ac; Boone County site 18011-701 (3,099 ac) corresponds to the LEAP district area. | IEDC | |
| May 19, 2022 | SSI Program Day at Indianapolis Motor Speedway: 1,793 sites identified; 40 counties with workshops; 961 sites reviewed; 302 ranked 4.0 to 5.0. | IEDC | |
| Aug 10, 2022 | WVPA Site Readiness Funding Grant Opportunity: counties completing workshops by Nov 11, 2022 receive an SSI Site Profile; program "entering its fourth year with almost 1,800 new greenfield sites." | WVPA / LEDOs | |
| Aug 23, 2022 | Pre-proposal for Pike County MegaSite assessment and marketing strategy (with Marketing Alliance). | IEDC | $95,700 proposed; not funded |
| Sep 27, 2022 | Proposal 22-068, SSI Program Advancement and Consulting Support (Jul 2022 to Jun 2023): consulting and RFI retainer; SSI Phase I Solar; 12 MegaSite and 12 Solar Site Profiles; 24 Business Attraction by NAICS Code flyers; landowner LOI and site advancement best practices; portal license. | IEDC | $233,500 |
| Nov 2, 2022 | IEDC publishes "SSI Program Zooms in on Tech Mega-park Sites": 1,700+ sites found, 69 mega-site candidates, Indiana first state to fund a statewide search. | IEDC | |
| Nov 4, 2022 | IEDC PSA 424112 executed (David Rosenberg, EVP); term Oct 1, 2022 to Dec 31, 2023. | IEDC | $233,500 NTE |
| Mar to Apr 2023 | Press release drafted (LL+D March 14; IEDC April 27) marking the 47th county workshop: 1,798 sites and 230,000 acres including 69 potential tech megaparks; 938 sites reviewed; 328 top-contender sites. | IEDC | |
| May 5, 2023 | IEDC publishes "Indiana Leads Nation on Strategic Site Identification" (Sec. Chambers, Ann Lathrop, Victor Leotta quoted). | IEDC | |
| May 11, 2023 | Rank 5.0 map: 88 sites ranked 5.0 of 646 ranked to date. | IEDC | |
| Aug 2, 2023 | Evansville I-64/US-41 XCEL cluster site maps (three sites, 1,156 to 2,271 acres). | IEDC / E-REP | |
| Aug 30, 2023 | SSI: Solar Phase I results statewide: 38 solar sites, 65,433 acres, 10,142 MW. | IEDC | $67,000 line |
| Aug 30, 2023 | Hoosier Energy SSI Phase II report, Henry County site 18065-040 (94.3 ac). | Hoosier Energy | $10,000 |
| Oct 23, 2023 | IEDC Phase II tracking at that date: 8 complete, 1 in progress, 2 scheduled, 13 nominated (24 total); the ninth report (Lowell) followed in December 2024; funders Duke 2, Hoosier 1, WVPA 15, NIPSCO and counties 5. | IEDC / Power Partners | |

| Date | Event, scope, or deliverable | Client / partner | Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| Nov 8, 2023 | Proposal 23-075 R1, on-demand SSI Program Advancement and Consulting Support, Nov 2023 to Dec 2024. | IEDC | $250,000 |
| Nov 15, 2023 | IEDC PSA 425361 executed. | IEDC | $250,000 NTE |
| Jan 26, 2024 | SSI Phase I versus ZoomProspector comparison complete: 1,743 sites in 92 counties; 54 counties reviewed; 406 sites ranked 4.0+ (77 with 250+ ac, 23 with 500+ ac); 1,473 SSI sites not within 1,000 feet of any ZoomProspector listing. | IEDC | |
| Jan to Feb 2024 | FLEX site class and filters built into the SSI Portal (sites over 100 acres, ranked 4+, no ZoomProspector match). | IEDC | |
| Mar to May 2024 | SSI Phase III Best Practices guidance drafted for IEDC (Draft V1, March 2024; not finalized when the program paused; clean edition issued November 2026); landowner engagement materials incorporated into workshops. | IEDC | |
| May 2024 | Project Evergreen RFI support for AES Indiana (hyperscale data center prospect; Morgan, Hendricks, Hancock, Marion County parcels). | IEDC / AES | |
| Jun 2024 | Project Osprey RFI support (Posey County data center sites, CenterPoint territory). | IEDC / CenterPoint | |
| Jun to Aug 2024 | SSI: Data Center Phase I for the 20-county NIPSCO service area (IEDC-funded): 15 hyperscale and 23 conventional candidates (38 sites). | IEDC / NIPSCO | |
| Jun 2024 | Ranking status: 1,385 sites reviewed; 491 ranked 4.0+ (254 at 4.0, 96 at 4.5, 141 at 5.0). | IEDC | |
| Jun 27, 2024 | Utility SSI Portal licenses invoiced directly to WVPA, Hoosier, NIPSCO, CenterPoint, Indiana Michigan Power, and IMPA for Jul 2024 to Jun 2025; AES asked in August. | Power Partners | $2,500 each |
| Jul 12, 2024 | PSA 425361 budget consumed ($249,846.50 of $250,000 billed). | IEDC | |
| Oct 1, 2024 | 2024-2025 Proposed SSI Program Budget Need memo to IEDC (rescreens, technical support, due diligence, technical marketing, SSI Portal, community revitalization); notes "Power Partners have slowed down on SSI Phase II investments as budgets are being reduced." | IEDC | no totals |
| Nov 12, 2024 | PSA 425361 Amendment 1 (Robert J. Paglia, COO); cap $275,000; term to Mar 31, 2025. | IEDC | +$25,000 |
| Nov 19, 2024 | Last Local Site Review Workshop (Kosciusko County): 74 of 92 counties complete (80.4%); 18 counties unscheduled. 2024 had 19 workshops. | IEDC / LEDOs | |
| Dec 18, 2024 | NIPSCO-funded SSI Phase II Findings Report, Lowell I-65 Industrial Park, Lake County. | NIPSCO | |
| Apr 1, 2025 | PSA 425361 Amendment 2 (Jeff Blade, Executive Director; Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) signed May 15, 2025); cap $300,000; term to Dec 31, 2025, "so that the Contractor may provide the IEDC with additional services." | IEDC | +$25,000 |

| Date | Event, scope, or deliverable | Client / partner | Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| Apr 29, 2025 | Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) acquired by ATK Energy Group and reconstituted as Location Design Group, LLC. | LDG | |
| May 6, 2025 | Draft Location Justification Scoring: Data Center Project Decision Support prepared for Matt Wade; proposes a Data Center and Traditional Industry Target Strategy Assessment; recommends "secure funding for SSI Program continuity." | IEDC | approx. $66,000 proposed; not contracted |
| Jun 20, 2025 | Invoice 25-025-01: site advancement support, Project Osprey and Project Evergreen RFI support, Data Center SSI Phase I for NIPSCO service area. Last IEDC invoice in the record. | IEDC | $25,000 |
| Jul to Aug 2025 | Statewide hyperscale data center evaluation: 58 candidate sites (345 kV within 500 feet, 400+ acres); SSI: Data Center Potential Site Analysis by Indiana Power Partner, under LDG branding. | IEDC / Power Partners | |
| Jul 2025 to Feb 2026 | Evansville Region I-69 Corridor Economic Development Study and SSI Executive Brief (36 SSI sites in the corridor). | E-REP / IEDC | |
| Dec 31, 2025 | PSA 425361 term expires. No Indiana workshops, Phase II, or Phase III activity recorded in 2025 or 2026 beyond the items above. | IEDC | |
| Nov 2026 | IEDC website continues to market the SSI Program: 1,811 sites, 235,402 acres, 74 counties reviewed, 490 sites ranked 4.0+, 70 potential mega sites. | IEDC | |
| Nov 2026 | LDG issues the clean edition of the SSI Phase III Best Practices Guidance (text and figures of the March 2024 draft corrected; recommendations unchanged) with this chronicle and the companion case. | LDG | |

# 5. Phases, products, and deliverables completed in Indiana

## 5.1 SSI Phase I: Site Discovery (2018 to 2021), all 92 counties

Phase I was delivered in two statewide passes. The original scope (PSA 420606, 2018 to February 2020) searched for Megasites of 1,000 acres or more and Heavy Industrial sites of 400 acres or more, delivered in ten batches. The Expanded Phase I (Proposal 20-007, 2020 to February 2021) added Light Industrial (150+ acres), Heavy Agribusiness (100+ acres), and General Agribusiness (50+ acres), delivered in batches E-01 through E-09. Each batch delivery comprised individual 11x17 site maps, county index maps, GIS site boundaries (shapefile, KML, and CAD) with site ID, total and buildable acreage, owner, parcel IDs, target land use, a sites summary table, and loading to the SSI Portal. By the final batch, 1,700 sites had been discovered with an average size of 194 acres, an average of 4.5 tracts and 1.8 owners per site, and an average 143 acres of potential developable area. Subsequent additions brought the inventory to 1,724 (May 2021), 1,793 (May 2022), 1,798 plus 69 Technology MegaSites (2023), and 1,811 as currently published by IEDC.

## 5.2 Local Site Review Workshops (December 2020 to November 2024), 74 of 92 counties

Each workshop convened the county economic development organization, planning and zoning, engineering and drainage, public works, utilities, the assessor, and elected officials to eliminate, modify, add, and rank every Phase I site in the county on the 1.0 to 5.0 scale, and to capture local knowledge of landowner disposition, zoning, and utility capacity. Workshops were held in 2 counties in 2020, 30 in 2021, 13 in 2022, 10 in 2023, and 19 in 2024. By June 2024, 1,385 sites had been reviewed and 491 ranked 4.0 or higher (254 at 4.0, 96 at 4.5, 141 at 5.0); 341 ranked 3.0 to 3.5; 355 ranked 1.0 to 2.5; 198 were eliminated or undetermined. Eighteen counties remain unreviewed: Carroll, Cass, Clay, Fayette, Fountain, Franklin, Gibson, Jefferson, Newton, Ohio, Owen, Pulaski, Sullivan, Switzerland, Tipton, Union, Warren, and Whitley.

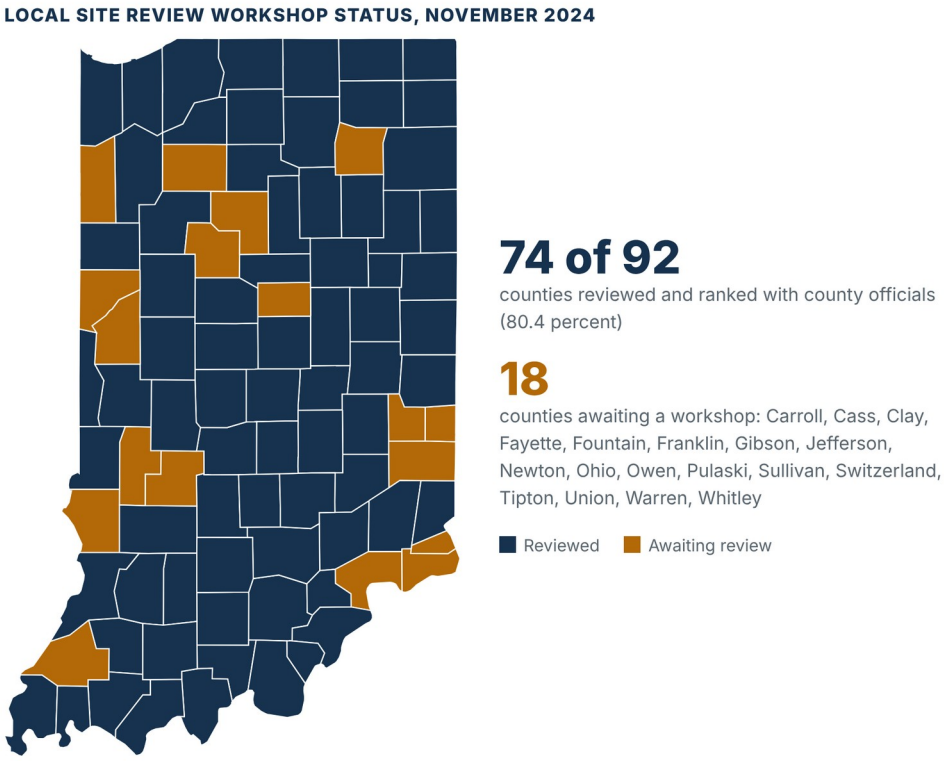



*Figure 2. Local Site Review Workshop status by county as of November 19, 2024 (74 of 92 counties complete).*

## 5.3 Expanded Phase I: Technology MegaSite Search (December 2021 to March 2022)

In 2021 the newly appointed Secretary of Commerce, Brad Chambers, gave the program a new mandate: find top-quality sites of more than 1,000 acres that could satisfy demand for hyper-scale technology parks near population centers of 50,000 or more, academic and research institutions, multimodal transportation, fiber, and existing industry. Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) screened 29 candidate counties at a 500-acre threshold and delivered 69 potential Technology MegaSites in 26 counties (Proposal 21-061, $65,250). The largest was a 5,200-acre site in Pike County; the Boone County site 18011-701 (3,099 acres) corresponds to the area that became the LEAP Research and Innovation District. IEDC's LEAP Lebanon brochure and web page describe the district's megasite, advanced manufacturing, mixed-use, and corporate campus settings as sitting "all on an SSI-certified

(Strategic Site Inventory) site." Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) also logged 104.5 hours of LEAP District technical support between June and November 2021 and drafted a Mega-Region vision and baseline asset mapping proposal in October 2021 at IEDC's direction.

## 5.4 SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence (2020 to 2024), 24 nominations, 9 complete

Phase II studies were funded by the Indiana Power Partners under a model that Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) helped design (NIPSCO's SSI Phase II Site Preparedness Grant Program, 80% utility and 20% local). Completed and funded studies include Duke Energy's Vermillion Rise Mega Park (1,162.7 acres, Vermillion County); Wabash Valley Power Alliance sites in Marshall County (735 acres), Tippecanoe County (Steele Industrial Site), Adams County, Parke County (Montezuma), and Boone County (Jamestown); NIPSCO sites in LaPorte County (Barr Industrial and Kingsbury Industrial Park), Porter County (Park 30 East), and Lake County (Lowell I-65 Industrial Park, Findings Report December 2024); and Hoosier Energy's Henry County site. IEDC's October 2023 tracker listed 24 sites in the Phase II pipeline with eight complete; the NIPSCO Lowell I-65 Findings Report followed in December 2024. The first SSI Phase II Candidate Site Index, an apolitical 100-point pre-due-diligence scoring of 4.0+ sites, was built for Wabash Valley in February 2022, and by July 2024 Candidate Site Indexes existed for roughly 35 counties.

## 5.5 SSI: Solar Phase I (2023)

Under PSA 424112, Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) ran a statewide utility-scale solar suitability screen and delivered 38 solar sites totaling 65,433 acres with an estimated 10,142 MW of capacity (average 1,722 acres, 266 MW, and 7.2 landowners per site), with 12 solar Site Profiles budgeted. The purpose was twofold: to give IEDC and the utilities a solar inventory, and to identify which industrial SSI sites were vulnerable to conversion to solar so that they could be protected.

## 5.6 SSI: Data Center and hyperscale support (2024 to 2025)

As hyperscale demand arrived, the program pivoted toward data center readiness. In mid-2024 IEDC funded an SSI Data Center Phase I for the 20-county NIPSCO service area (15 hyperscale and 23 conventional candidates). Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) supported two hyperscale RFIs, Project Evergreen (AES Indiana, May 2024) and Project Osprey (Posey County, CenterPoint territory, June 2024), and in July and August 2025 produced a statewide hyperscale data center evaluation of 58 candidate sites with 345 kV transmission within 500 feet and 400 or more acres, plus a potential site analysis by Indiana Power Partner that overlaid legacy coal plant 25-mile buffers. A May 2025 draft, Location Justification Scoring: Data Center Project Decision Support, proposed a Data Center and Traditional Industry Target Strategy Assessment to help IEDC decide where to encourage or discourage hyperscale development; it was not contracted.

## 5.7 Site Profiles, NAICS brochures, and technical marketing

IEDC commissioned SSI Phase I Site Profiles in 2021 (25 to 32 profiles, $49,600) and, under PSA 424112, 12 MegaSite and Tech MegaPark profiles, 12 solar profiles, and 24 Business Attraction by NAICS Code flyers. By July 2024 the product inventory showed Site Profiles for 17 sites, six Expanded (XCEL) profiles, and desktop wetlands assessments for seven sites. The NAICS brochure assigns four-digit NAICS subsectors to a site based on local targets tempered by a 45-minute drive-time labor

review; this NAICS tagging is the attribute that makes a site machine-matchable in the SSI: Signals lead generation engine (see companion document).

## 5.8 SSI Phase I versus ZoomProspector comparison (2023 to 2024)

To quantify how much new inventory the program created, Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) compared every SSI Phase I site with IEDC's ZoomProspector listings. Of 1,743 SSI sites, 1,473 were not within 1,000 feet of any ZoomProspector listing. Among the 406 sites ranked 4.0 or higher in the 54 reviewed counties at that date, 77 exceeded 250 acres and 23 exceeded 500 acres. The result underpins the FLEX and Focus Site classes and is the clearest single measure of the program's added value: roughly 85 percent of the inventory did not exist in Indiana's public site database before SSI.

## 5.9 The SSI Portal (2018 to 2025)

The SSI Portal is the secure, map-based system of record for every Indiana SSI site, developed and maintained by LDG's Josh Ong. Nine Indiana instances were deployed: the IEDC parent portal (in.strategicsitesinventory.com) and eight utility portals filtered to each partner's service territory (Duke, AES/IPL, Wabash, Hoosier, IMPA, NIPSCO, Indiana Michigan Power, and Vectren/CenterPoint). IEDC funded 107 REDO and LEDO sub-licenses from November 2020 and renewed LEDO access through June 30, 2025; roughly 27 LEDO users had registered by mid-2022. Features added for Indiana include FLEX, Solar, and XCEL source filters, utility territory filters, transmission and substation kV filtering, ZoomProspector cross-links, measuring tools, and parcel record links. IEDC's own 2024 budget memo called the portal a "mission critical resource for IEDC and its LEDOs" that IEDC's site selection manager "uses frequently to search for sites for RFI response."

## 5.10 RFI and project support (2021 to 2025)

Throughout the program Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) provided on-demand RFI technical support to IEDC's site selection staff, drawing on the inventory for prospect responses including Bartholomew County, Warsaw, Project Bravado, Daviess, Lawrence, Washington and Kokomo, Floyd, Project Evergreen, and Project Osprey, together with Indiana Ports, Evansville I-64/US-41 XCEL, and LEAP District support. Site rescreening for upcoming workshops (Elkhart, Kosciusko, Huntington, Wells, Adams, Ripley) was performed in 2024.

## 5.11 Communications and outreach

The program was introduced to Indiana's economic development community through the September 24, 2020 IEDC webinar; sponsored and presented at Indy Fast Friday (May 21, 2021) and SSI Program Day at the Indianapolis Motor Speedway (May 19, 2022); announced nationally through IEDC's November 2, 2022 and May 5, 2023 releases, which were carried by Trade and Industry Development, Expansion Solutions, The Center Square, and regional press; and proposed as an IEDA annual conference panel in 2022. Deliverables to the utilities included Phase I summary sheets and Focus Site sheets by territory (November 2021) and the Power Partner portal program (August 2024).

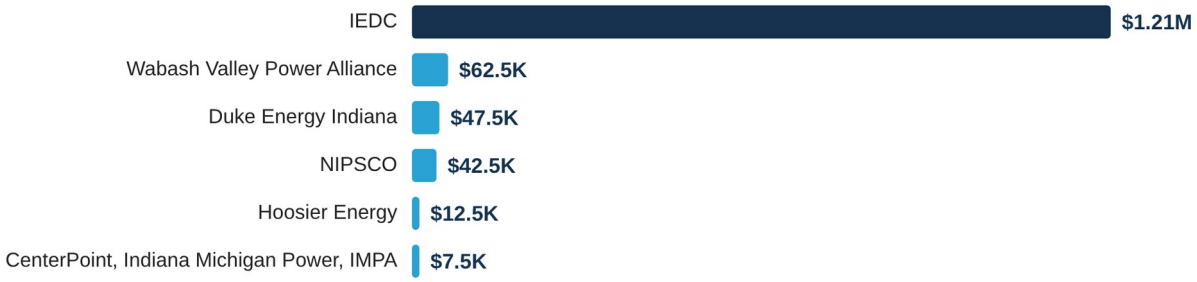
# 6. Clients, contracts, and investment

## 6.1 IEDC contracts

| Agreement | Executed | Term | Scope | Not-to-exceed |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| PSA 420606 | Dec 3, 2018 | Dec 2018 to Dec 31, 2022 (5 amendments) | SSI Phase I (Megasite, Heavy Industrial); Expanded Phase I (Light Industrial, Agribusiness); Technology MegaSite search; portal licenses; technical support | $679,935.04 |
| PSA 424112 | Nov 4, 2022 | Oct 1, 2022 to Dec 31, 2023 | SSI: Solar Phase I; 24 Site Profiles; 24 NAICS flyers; landowner LOI and best practices; RFI retainer; portal license | $233,500.00 |
| PSA 425361 | Nov 15, 2023 | Nov 1, 2023 to Dec 31, 2025 (2 amendments) | On-demand program advancement and consulting support; portal and LEDO access; data center Phase I; RFI support | $300,000.00 |

## 6.2 Investment by client, 2018 to 2025 (invoiced)

FIGURE 3. INVESTMENT BY CLIENT, 2018 TO 2025 (INVOICED)



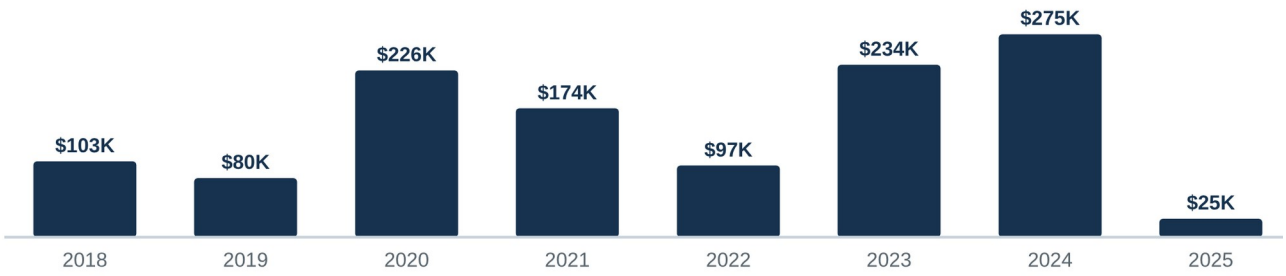

| Client | Scope | Invoiced |
|---|---|---|
| Indiana Economic Development Corporation | Phase I statewide (two passes), Technology MegaSite search, Solar Phase I, data center Phase I (NIPSCO area), workshops, portal and LEDO access, site profiles, NAICS flyers, technical support, RFI support | $1,213,282.04 |
| Duke Energy Indiana | Phase II (2 sites, Vermillion Rise); SSI Portal license every year 2020 to 2025 | $47,500.00 |
| Wabash Valley Power Alliance | Phase II (6 sites); SSI Portal 2024-25 | $62,500.00 |
| NIPSCO | Phase II (5 sites: LaPorte, Lake, Porter, Kingsbury); SSI Portal 2024-25 | $42,500.00 |
| Hoosier Energy | Phase II (Henry County); SSI Portal 2024-25 | $12,500.00 |
| CenterPoint Energy (Vectren) | SSI Portal 2024-25 | $2,500.00 |

| Client | Scope | Invoiced |
|---|---|---|
| Indiana Michigan Power (AEP) | SSI Portal 2024-25 | $2,500.00 |
| Indiana Municipal Power Agency | SSI Portal 2024-25 | $2,500.00 |
| **Total, all Indiana clients** | | **$1,385,782.04** |

Notes: IEDC figures reconcile to LL+D's Budget and Billing History 2018-2024 ($1,188,282.04 through invoice 23-075-08, dated October 14, 2024; an apparent re-issue dated November 19, 2024 is excluded) plus invoice 25-025-01 ($25,000, June 20, 2025). Figures are net of a $25,000 in-kind services credit for Indy Fast Friday sponsorship. AES Indiana was invited to license its own portal in August 2024. NIPSCO's 2024-25 portal access also appears as a line within IEDC invoice 23-075-07.

## 6.3 IEDC investment by year

FIGURE 4. IEDC INVESTMENT BY YEAR, IN THOUSANDS




| Year | IEDC invoiced | Principal activity |
|---|---|---|
| 2018 | $102,799.00 | Project initiation; portal license |
| 2019 | $79,933.50 | Phase I Megasite and Heavy Industrial batches 1 to 6 |
| 2020 | $225,680.00 | Phase I complete; Expanded Phase I; REDO/LEDO portal access; first workshops |
| 2021 | $174,439.50 | Expanded Phase I complete; 30 workshops; site profiles; Technology MegaSite search begins |
| 2022 | $97,083.04 | Technology MegaSite search complete; technical support reconciliation; SSI Day |
| 2023 | $233,500.00 | Solar Phase I; profiles; NAICS flyers; landowner best practices; RFI retainer |
| 2024 | $274,847.00 | On-demand support; 19 workshops; ZoomProspector comparison; data center Phase I; portal and LEDO access |
| 2025 | $25,000.00 | Data center RFI support; last invoice June 20, 2025 |
| **Total** | **$1,213,282.04** | |

## 6.4 Investment by phase and product (all Indiana clients)

FIGURE 5. INVESTMENT BY PHASE AND PRODUCT, ALL INDIANA CLIENTS



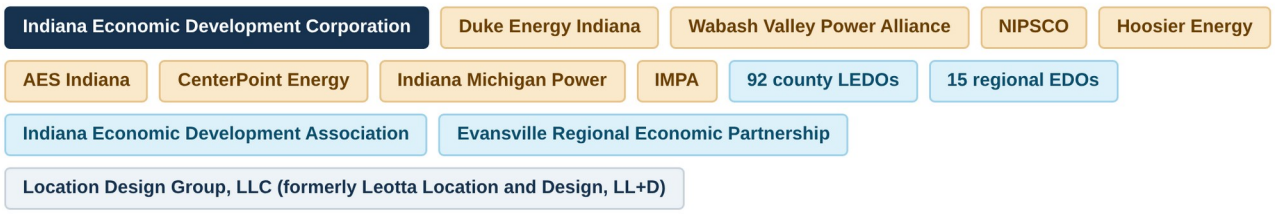
Phase I discovery, specialty screens, workshops $562.2K
SSI Portal licensing $261.0K
Phase II due diligence (utilities) $130.0K
Program management, RFI, technical support $324.0K
Site Profiles, NAICS brochures $133.6K

| Phase or product | Invoiced | Share |
|---|---|---|
| Phase I Site Discovery (Megasite, Heavy and Light Industrial, Agribusiness, Technology MegaSite, workshops) | $495,162.50 | 35.7% |
| Solar Phase I | $67,000.00 | 4.8% |
| Phase II Preliminary Due Diligence (Duke, WVPA, NIPSCO, Hoosier) | $130,000.00 | 9.4% |
| SSI Portal licensing (IEDC, LEDO/REDO, utility portals) | $260,997.00 | 18.8% |
| Site Profiles, NAICS brochures, marketing collateral | $133,600.00 | 9.6% |
| Program management, RFI support, data center and technical consulting | $324,022.54 | 23.4% |
| In-kind credit (Indy Fast Friday) | ($25,000.00) | (1.8%) |
| **Total** | **$1,385,782.04** | **100%** |

No invoice was ever issued under a Phase III (Site Advancement to Market) heading. Landowner engagement best practices and LOI templates were produced in 2023 and 2024 (the Phase III Best Practices Guidance, Draft V1, March 2024, issued as a clean edition in November 2026) and incorporated into workshops, but no Indiana site has been carried through landowner engagement to a purchase option and graduation.

# 7. Partners and people

FIGURE 6. PROGRAM PARTNERS




## 7.1 IEDC

Program sponsors and signatories across three administrations of IEDC leadership: James A. Schellinger, Secretary of Commerce (2018 agreement); James M. Staton, Interim Secretary (2021 amendment); Bradley B. Chambers, Secretary of Commerce (2021 and 2022 amendments; the Technology MegaSite mandate); David Rosenberg, Executive Vice President (2022 agreement); Robert J. Paglia, Chief Operating Officer (2024 amendment); and Jeff Blade, Executive Director (2025 amendment). Day-to-day program leadership sat with Matt Wade, Vice President of Marketing and later Senior Vice President of Sales and Marketing, supported by Sarah Salisbury, Site Selection Manager

(workshop scheduling, RFI responses, portal user). Ann Lathrop, Chief Strategy Officer, and Erin Sweitzer, communications, carried the 2023 public announcements.

## 7.2 Indiana Power Partners

| Utility | Role in the program | Contacts in the record |
|---|---|---|
| Duke Energy Indiana | Originating partner (2018 Duke Energy Foundation grant to IEDC); funded its own SSI Portal every year 2020 to 2025; Phase II for Vermillion Rise Mega Park; 2023 capacity review of 10 SSI sites; Phase III landowner engagement outline; 2025 data center overview | Erin Schneider, Director, Economic Development; Haley Tomlinson |
| Wabash Valley Power Alliance | Largest Phase II funder (15-site program, 6 funded); first Candidate Site Index; 2022 workshop incentive program (Site Profile for counties completing workshops); portal licensee | Jennifer Hooper; Brian D. Anderson, Director, Economic Development; Rachel Huser |
| NIPSCO | SSI Phase II Site Preparedness Grant Program (80/20 with LEDOs); five Phase II sites; 2024 Data Center Phase I territory; portal licensee | Cindy Admave, Economic Development Manager |
| Hoosier Energy | Phase II (Henry County); portal licensee | Jeff Pipkin, Economic Development Manager |
| AES Indiana (IPL) | Project Evergreen hyperscale RFI (2024); portal user; 2024 letter: "The Indiana SSI Program continues to achieve milestones and produce ROI." | Economic development staff (2024 correspondence) |
| CenterPoint Energy (Vectren) | Largest Phase I territory (793 sites); Project Osprey (Posey County); portal licensee | James Bundren; Brian Gildea |
| Indiana Michigan Power (AEP) | Phase I territory (251 sites); portal licensee | Economic development staff |
| Indiana Municipal Power Agency | Phase I territory (180 sites); portal licensee | Economic development staff |

## 7.3 Local and regional partners

All 92 county economic development organizations and 15 regional organizations received SSI Portal access funded by IEDC, and 74 counties hosted Local Site Review Workshops. Local partners named in Phase II work include Vermillion County EDC and Vermillion Rise Mega Park (Bob Grewe), Greater Lafayette Commerce, Boone EDC, Kosciusko EDC, LaPorte County Economic Alliance, Jackson County IDC (Jim Plump), and Harrison County EDC (Darrell Voelker). The Evansville Regional Economic Partnership engaged LDG for the I-64/US-41 XCEL cluster (2023) and the I-69 Corridor Economic Development Study (2025 to 2026). The Indiana Economic Development Association Foundation co-hosted the 2020 program webinar. Marketing Alliance (David Petr) co-authored the 2022 Pike County MegaSite and IEDA panel proposals, and MKM & Associates (Mark K. Miller) presented landowner relations at the 2020 webinar.

### 7.4 LDG team

Victor Leotta (program creator and manager); Holden Simoneaux (lead site analyst and GIS); Chris Ventre, PLA (technical director); William Paul, P.E. (engineering quality assurance); Josh Ong (SSI Portal developer); Katy Fell (site quality and design); Tina Morgan (site quality analyst, ZoomProspector comparison); and LEO, LLC (Leotta-Evers Consulting), where the SSI methodology and portal originated. Since April 29, 2025 the firm has operated as Location Design Group, LLC, an ATK Energy Group Company.

## 8. Results and metrics

### 8.1 Inventory growth

FIGURE 7. INVENTORY GROWTH AND RANKING PROGRESS




| As of | Sites identified | Counties searched | Workshops complete | Sites reviewed | Ranked 4.0+ | Source |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Feb 2020 | 237 | 87 of 92 | 0 | | | Utility partner introduction |
| Oct 2020 | 977 | 92 | 0 | | | Proposal 20-051 |
| Feb 2021 | 1,700 | 92 | 2 | | | Batch E-09 delivery |
| May 2021 | 1,724 | 92 | 23 | 495 | 235 | Indy Fast Friday |
| May 2022 | 1,793 | 92 | 40 | 961 | 302 | SSI Program Day |
| Apr 2023 | 1,798 + 69 tech megasites | 92 | 47 | 938 | 328 top contenders | IEDC release |
| Jan 2024 | 1,743 (ZP comparison set) | 92 | 54 | 1,096 | 406 | ZoomProspector comparison |
| Jun 2024 | | 92 | about 70 (74 by Nov 2024) | 1,385 | 491 (141 at 5.0) | Ranking chart |
| Nov 2024 | | 92 | 74 (80.4%) | | | Status tracking |

| As of | Sites identified | Counties searched | Workshops complete | Sites reviewed | Ranked 4.0+ | Source |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Nov 2026 | 1,811 / 235,402 ac | 92 | 74 | | 490; 70 potential mega sites | IEDC website |

## 8.2 What the inventory contains

- Sites range from roughly 25 to 5,200 acres; the Phase I average is 194 acres with 143 acres of potential developable area. Of the 406 sites ranked 4.0+ in January 2024, 77 exceeded 250 acres and 23 exceeded 500 acres.
- 88 sites had been ranked 5.0 by May 2023 (13.6 percent of ranked sites); 141 by June 2024.
- Land uses covered: Megasite, Heavy Industrial, Light Industrial, Heavy and General Agribusiness, Distribution and Logistics, Business and Technology Park, Technology MegaSite, Utility-scale Solar (38 sites, 10,142 MW), and Data Center (58 statewide hyperscale candidates; 38 in NIPSCO territory).
- 1,473 of 1,743 sites (85 percent) were not within 1,000 feet of any ZoomProspector listing; the program created, rather than catalogued, Indiana's greenfield inventory.
- Every site carries a FIPS-based Site ID, acreage, owner and parcel data, land use class, transportation and utility attributes, and (where reviewed) a competitive rank, and is stored in the SSI Portal with its maps and documents.

## 8.3 Institutional adoption

IEDC adopted the SSI Program as a formal site readiness initiative in 2020, branded it on its website under Find Sites alongside Featured Sites and Plug-in Ready Sites, and in 2022 and 2023 used it as the basis for two national press releases under Secretary Chambers. The State Budget Committee presentation of December 14, 2022 framed strategic sites under the slide heading "speed is new incentive" and noted that competing states (Ohio, Michigan, Tennessee, North Carolina, Texas, Georgia) had already invested in strategic sites; HEA 1001 (2023) appropriated $150 million for a 2024 to 2025 Site Acquisition Fund "to support the IEDC's strategic sites initiative" (state land purchase for IEDC's own Strategic Sites Initiative; not shown to have continued past 2025). The LEAP Research and Innovation District, Indiana's flagship strategic site, is marketed by IEDC as an SSI-certified site and now hosts Eli Lilly's $18 billion campus and Meta's $10 billion data center. As of November 2026 the IEDC website still presents the SSI inventory as "the most comprehensive in the nation."

## 8.4 What has not yet happened

The record is equally clear about what the program has not yet produced. No Indiana SSI site has completed Phase III landowner engagement, secured site control, and graduated to the public sites and buildings database. Phase II due diligence has been completed on nine sites (eight in IEDC's October 2023 tracker plus the December 2024 Lowell I-65 report) of 490 ranked 4.0 or higher. Eighteen counties have never had their sites reviewed. Site Profiles exist for about 17 sites and NAICS brochures for fewer. The inventory is therefore largely at the discovery and ranking stage: identified, vetted locally, and ranked, but not yet documented, controlled, or marketed. That gap is the subject of the companion document.

# 9. Program status in November 2026

## 9.1 Funding

IEDC funding did not end by decision; it tapered. The $250,000 budget under PSA 425361 was fully consumed by July 12, 2024, during the program's busiest workshop year since 2021. The two amendments that followed, in November 2024 and April 2025, added $25,000 each, and the second was signed in April 2025, three months after the change of state administration in January 2025 and during the 2025 budget session in which IEDC's overall appropriation was reduced by about 25 percent. The last IEDC invoice was issued on June 20, 2025, and the agreement expired on December 31, 2025. The utilities, which had funded Phase II at $10,000 per site, had by October 2024 "slowed down on SSI Phase II investments as budgets are being reduced," and their SSI Portal licenses were shifted from IEDC's budget to direct $2,500 annual invoices in June 2024.

## 9.2 What is intact

- The complete Phase I inventory for all 92 counties, with GIS boundaries, maps, ownership data, and summary tables, delivered to IEDC and resident in the SSI Portal.
- Workshop rankings for 74 counties (1,385 sites reviewed; 490 at 4.0 or higher; 141 at 5.0).
- The Technology MegaSite (69 sites), Solar (38 sites), and Data Center (58 sites) specialty inventories.
- Nine completed Phase II reports (the ninth, Lowell I-65 Industrial Park, delivered December 2024), Candidate Site Indexes for roughly 35 counties, 17 Site Profiles, six Expanded XCEL profiles, and the ZoomProspector comparison.
- The SSI Portal infrastructure (nine Indiana instances), the Power Partner relationships, the LEDO user base, and the Phase III best practices and landowner engagement materials.
- IEDC's public branding of SSI on its website and in its LEAP marketing.

## 9.3 What is at risk




- Eighteen counties with unreviewed Phase I sites, including Gibson, Sullivan, and Clay in the I-69 and I-70 corridors.

- Data currency: Phase I imagery and parcel data date from 2018 to 2021; ownership, zoning, solar conversion, and data center absorption have changed conditions on an unknown share of sites. Workshop rescreening was underway in 2024 and stopped.
- SSI Portal access: IEDC and LEDO access was funded through June 30, 2025 and the utility licenses through June 30, 2025 (Duke Energy through December 31, 2025). Without renewal the system of record goes dark for the people who use it for RFI responses.
- Partner momentum: the utilities and LEDOs built budget lines and workshop calendars around the program; a pause of more than a year converts a running program into a restart.
- Competitive position: since 2023, Ohio (about $350 million awarded through the All Ohio Future Fund before the fund was cut in 2025, plus JobsOhio's $250 million site inventory program), Illinois ($500 million), Michigan ($460 million), Kentucky ($170 million), and Virginia ($282 million) have funded site readiness at scale while Indiana's identified inventory sits unadvanced.

> **Bottom line**
>
> Indiana paid approximately $1.39 million over seven years for the discovery, local vetting, and ranking of the largest greenfield inventory of any state in the SSI Program, plus the specialty mega-site, solar, and data center screens and the portal that holds it all. The program stopped at the threshold of the phases that convert inventory into projects. The companion document sets out what it would take to finish.

# Appendix A: Source register

All facts in this chronicle are drawn from the following records in the LDG archive and from IEDC's public communications. Drive and archive file identifiers are available on request.

### IEDC agreements and amendments

- Professional Services Agreement 420606, executed December 3, 2018, and Amendments 1 (Dec 2019), 2 (Mar 2020), 3 (May 2021), 4 (Dec 2021), and 5 (Feb 2022).
- Professional Services Agreement 424112, executed November 4, 2022 (requisition 000000009705).
- Professional Services Agreement 425361, executed November 15, 2023, and Amendments 1 (Nov 12, 2024) and 2 (Apr 1, 2025; signed May 15, 2025).

### Proposals and budgets

- Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) Proposals 18-044 (R0 Aug 29, 2018; R1 Oct 29, 2018), 20-007 (R1 Feb 27, 2020), 20-050 (Oct 12, 2020), 20-051 (Oct 16, 2020), 21-040 in-kind letter (May 12, 2021), 21-047 draft (Oct 21, 2021), 21-056 (Aug 24, 2021), 21-061 (R1 Nov 30, 2021), 21-065 (Dec 22, 2021), 22-068 (Sep 27, 2022), 23-075 (R1 Nov 8, 2023).
- Duke Energy Indiana proposals 18-045 (Mar 2018), 18-044 (Aug 2018), 20-027 (Feb 20, 2020); FY2020 Budgetary Consideration (Sep 17, 2019); Electric Utility Partner budget template (Feb 25, 2020).
- Wabash Valley Power Alliance proposal 21-038 (May 18, 2021; R1 Jul 12, 2021); NIPSCO proposal 21-044 (Oct 8, 2021) and grant program framework (Sep 30, 2021).
- 2024-2025 Proposed SSI Program Budget Need by Category (Oct 1, 2024); Location Justification Scoring draft (May 6, 2025); Pike County MegaSite pre-proposal (Aug 23, 2022).

### Billing records

- LL+D Budget and Billing History 2018-2024 (compiled Jan 9, 2025); LL+D IEDC Billing Summaries (May 3, 2021; Sep 22, 2021; Jun 21, 2023); IEDC invoices 18-044-01 through 25-025-01; Duke Energy Indiana, WVPA, NIPSCO, Hoosier Energy, CenterPoint, Indiana Michigan Power, and IMPA invoices 2019 to 2024; Leotta Location and Design (LL+D)/LDG 2025 project tracker.

### Deliverables, status, and metrics

- Project kickoff deck (Jan 31, 2019); Phase I batch delivery summary sheets E-05 to E-09 (Oct 2020 to Feb 2021); Indiana SSI Program Status Tracking workbook; Local Site Review Status maps (Oct 2020, Mar 2023, Nov 2024); Power Partner Phase I summary sheets and Focus Site sheets (2021); Technology MegaSite summary table (Mar 25, 2022); Rank 5.0 map (May 11, 2023); SSI Solar one-pager (Aug 30, 2023); Phase II tracking (Oct 23, 2023); SSI Phase I versus ZoomProspector final report (Jan 2024); ranking chart (Jun 2024); SSI products inventory (Jul 1, 2024); Data Center site rankings and Power Partner overview (Jul to Aug 2025); Vermillion Rise, WVPA, NIPSCO, and Hoosier Phase II reports; Indy Fast Friday and SSI Program Day decks (2021, 2022); IPP SSI Portals letter (Aug 22, 2024); Evansville I-69 Corridor Study and Executive Brief (2025 to 2026).

### SSI Program methodology

- SSI Phase I Methodology (2020); SSI Phase I Deliverables (Apr 2021); SSI Program versus Sites and Buildings and Certified Sites; SSI FAQ v3.0; SSI Phase III Process Overview (Oct 2020) and Best Practices; SSI Market Readiness Workflow; SSI Portal Requirements and Site Attribution; LDG Service Catalog (2022 to 2025); LDG SSI Site Selection Experience (Sep 2026).

### IEDC and public sources

- IEDC, Indiana SSI Sites web page (iedc.in.gov/indiana-ssi-sites), as viewed November 2026 and January 2024.
- IEDC, LEAP Lebanon web page and LEAP Lebanon brochure (2023).
- IEDC news releases: "IEDC's Strategic Sites Inventory Program Zooms in on Tech Mega-park Sites" (Nov 2, 2022); "Indiana Leads Nation on Strategic Site Identification Spurring Economic Opportunity" (May 5, 2023); "Indiana's Unprecedented Economic Momentum to Continue with Robust Legislative Support" (May 4, 2023).
- IEDC presentation to the State Budget Committee (Dec 14, 2022); Trade and Industry Development, The Center Square, Expansion Solutions, and Reporter.net coverage (May 2023); TechPoint and Indiana Capital Chronicle year-end coverage (Jan 2024); Daily Journal and Inside Indiana Business coverage of LEAP (2025 to 2026).